

NEOLITHIC & CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES

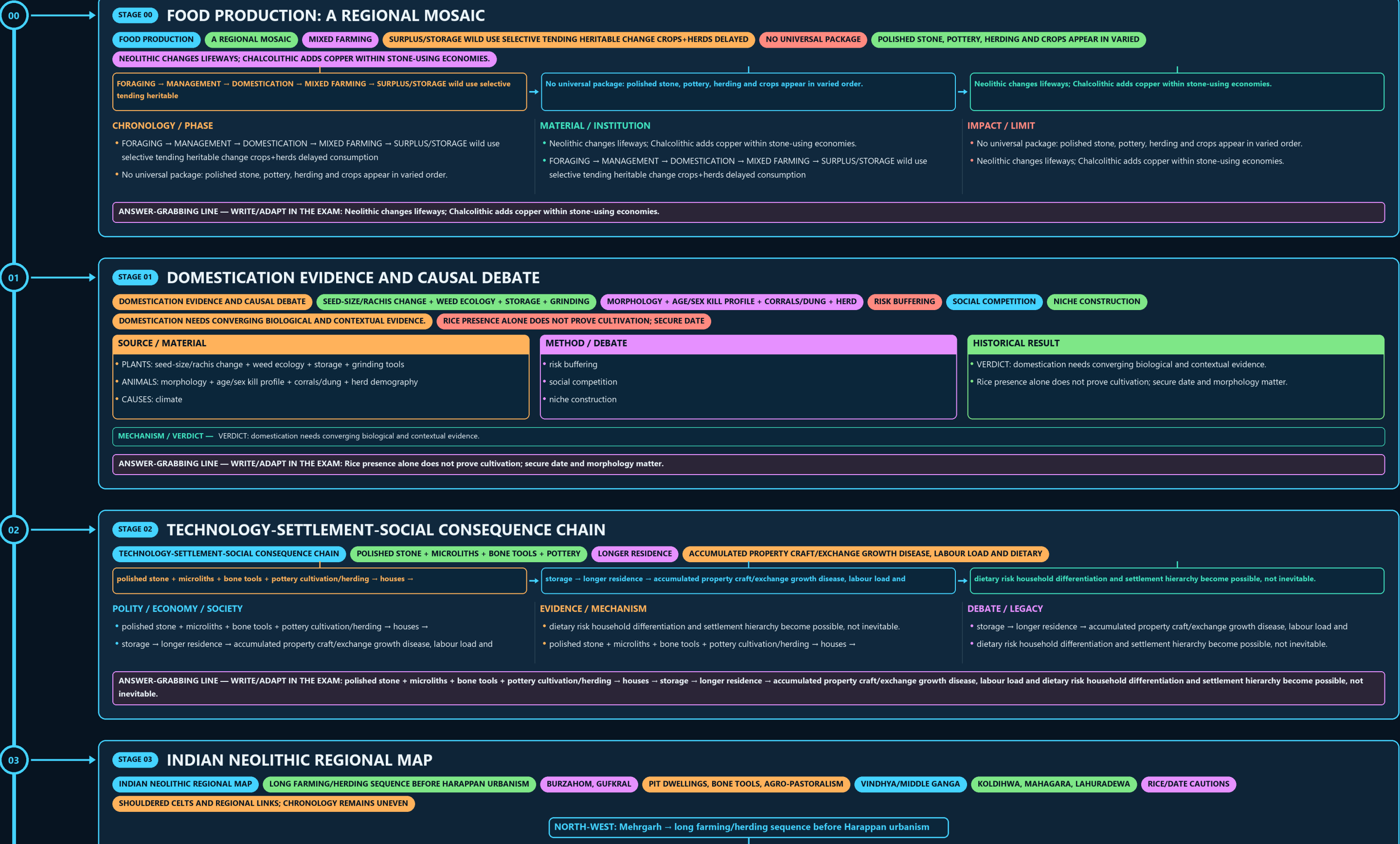
FOOD PRODUCTION: A REGIONAL → DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL → TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN → INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP → ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE → CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g15 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

03

STAGE 03 INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP

INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP LONG FARMING/HERDING SEQUENCE BEFORE HARAPPAN URBANISM BURZAHOM, GUFKRAL PIT DWELLINGS, BONE TOOLS, AGRO-PASTORALISM VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA KOLDIHW, MAHAGARA, LAHURADEWA RICE/DATE CAUTIONS

SHOULDERED CELTS AND REGIONAL LINKS; CHRONOLOGY REMAINS UNEVEN

KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral → pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism

NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh → long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism

VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa → rice/date cautions

NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh → long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism
- KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral → pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa → rice/date cautions
- NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SOUTH: Utnur, Piklihal, Tekkalakota, Hallur → cattle, millets, ash mounds
- RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

04

STAGE 04 ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE

ASH MOUNDS FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND PERIODIC PEN BURNING COMMUNAL FEASTING REPEATED FIRING AND CATTLE CENTRALITY ARE STRONG; ONE EXCLUSIVE

USE UTNUR AND RELATED SITES AS A PASTORAL-LANDSCAPE PROBLEM

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT → SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND periodic pen burning communal feasting sanitation/fuel practice
- Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.

METHOD / DEBATE

- Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.
- BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT → SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND periodic pen burning communal feasting sanitation/fuel practice

HISTORICAL RESULT

- Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.
- Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

05

STAGE 05 CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS GANESHWAR-JODHPURA GANESHWAR/JODHPURA COPPER CRAFT; HARAPPAN CONTACT AHAR-BANAS AHAR, BALATHAL, GILUND BLACK-RED WARE; COPPER; FARMING

KAYATHA KAYATHA EARLY MALWA SEQUENCE; RICH DEPOSITS MALWA NAVDATOLI, ERAN, NAGDA PAINTED WARE; LARGE VILLAGES; SPREAD JORWE INAMGAON, NEVASA DECCAN HIERARCHY; LATE JORWE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS

Ganeshwar-Jodhpura Ganeshwar/Jodhpura copper craft; Harappan contact

Ahar-Banas Ahar, Balathal, Gilund black-red ware; copper; farming

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

Kayatha Kayatha early Malwa sequence; rich deposits

Malwa Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda painted ware; large villages; spread

Jorwe Inamgaon, Nevasa Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe

DEBATE / LEGACY

OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS
- Ganeshwar-Jodhpura Ganeshwar/Jodhpura copper craft; Harappan contact
- Ahar-Banas Ahar, Balathal, Gilund black-red ware; copper; farming

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Kayatha Kayatha early Malwa sequence; rich deposits
- Malwa Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda painted ware; large villages; spread
- Jorwe Inamgaon, Nevasa Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe

DEBATE / LEGACY

- OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label.

06

STAGE 06 CHALCOLITHIC RURAL POLITICAL ECONOMY

CHALCOLITHIC RURAL POLITICAL ECONOMY VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS CROP/HERD PRODUCTION CRAFT WORK EXCHANGE UNEQUAL HOUSES RISK AND SURPLUS COPPER/POTTERY REGIONAL NETWORKS SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY AND DIFFERENTIAL BURIALS MAY INDICATE INEQUALITY.

MOST SYSTEMS WERE REGIONAL AND RURAL, NOT FAILED HARAPPAN

VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk

Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

06

Ahar-Banas Ahar, Balathal, Gilund black-red ware; copper; farming

Jorwe Inamgaon, Nevasa Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label.

STAGE 06

CHALCOLITHIC RURAL POLITICAL ECONOMY

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VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS

CROP/HERD PRODUCTION

CRAFT WORK

EXCHANGE UNEQUAL HOUSES RISK AND SURPLUS COPPER/POTTERY REGIONAL NETWORKS

SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY AND DIFFERENTIAL BURIALS MAY INDICATE INEQUALITY.

MOST SYSTEMS WERE REGIONAL AND RURAL, NOT FAILED HARAPPAN

VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS — crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk

Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks

Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks

DEBATE / LEGACY

Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

07

STAGE 07

DECLINE, TRANSFORMATION AND CULTURAL LABELS

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LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE

ARIDITY + PRODUCTION STRESS + SETTLEMENT REORGANISATION SOME ABANDONMENT

CAUTION 1

ARCHAEOLOGICAL CULTURE

MATERIAL PATTERN, NOT A NAMED PEOPLE.

CAUTION 2

COPPER USE DOES NOT DISPLACE STONE OR PROVE URBANISATION.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some

abandonment + smaller settlements + mobile strategies + local continuity

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

CAUTION 1: archaeological culture = material pattern, not a named people.

CAUTION 2: copper use does not displace stone or prove urbanisation.

DEBATE / LEGACY

CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.

LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.

08

STAGE 08

NEOLITHIC-CHALCOLITHIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

NEOLITHIC-CHALCOLITHIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10 MARKS

DEFINE PHASE

TWO REGIONAL SITES

EVIDENCE CAUTION

15 MARKS

TRANSITION CAUSES

DOMESTICATION PROOF

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

10 MARKS: define phase → process → two regional sites → evidence caution

15 MARKS: transition causes → domestication proof → technology/settlement → comparison

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

20 MARKS: mosaic chronology → regional map → Chalcolithic matrix → economy/society

ash-mound debate → transformation → qualified synthesis

DEBATE / LEGACY

Use triads: region + site + marker; never write an undifferentiated site catalogue.

CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

09

STAGE 09

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

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EVIDENCE LADDER

1. TEST CULTIVATION, DOMESTICATION, SEDENTISM, POTTERY AND STORAGE SEPARATELY.

2. ANCHOR EVERY CULTURE IN REGION, SITE, ASSEMBLAGE AND

3. TREAT ADOPTION, LOCAL DEVELOPMENT, MOBILITY AND INTERACTION AS

NEOLITHISATION IS A REGIONAL MOSAIC, NOT ONE REVOLUTION OR

SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
EVIDENCE LADDER	2. Anchor every culture in region, site, assemblage and dated sequence.	VERDICT: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.
1. Test cultivation, domestication, sedentism, pottery and storage separately.	3. Treat adoption, local development, mobility and interaction as testable models.	EVIDENCE LADDER

SOURCE / MATERIAL

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Test cultivation, domestication, sedentism, pottery and storage separately.

METHOD / DEBATE

2. Anchor every culture in region, site, assemblage and dated sequence.

3. Treat adoption, local development, mobility and interaction as testable models.

HISTORICAL RESULT

VERDICT: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.

EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.

NEOLITHIC & CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 5259-8493 of 11122 • continues below

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Test cultivation, domestication, sedentism, pottery and storage separately.

SOURCE / MATERIAL

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Test cultivation, domestication, sedentism, pottery and storage separately.

METHOD / DEBATE

2. Anchor every culture in region, site, assemblage and dated sequence.

3. Treat adoption, local development, mobility and interaction as testable models.

VERDICT: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.

EVIDENCE LADDER

HISTORICAL RESULT

VERDICT: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.

EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.

10

STAGE 10

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. RICE PRESENCE IS NOT DOMESTICATION; A POLISHED CELT

2. CHALCOLITHIC MEANS COPPER PLUS STONE, NOT UNIVERSAL METAL

3. OCP, COPPER HOARDS AND GANESHWAR OVERLAP PARTLY BUT

CULTURE LABELS CLASSIFY ASSEMBLAGES; THEY DO NOT PROVE ETHNICITY

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Rice presence is not domestication; a polished celt alone is not farming.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

2. Chalcolithic means copper plus stone, not universal metal use or urbanism.

3. OCP, copper hoards and Ganeshwar overlap partly but are not one people.

DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: Culture labels classify assemblages; they do not prove ethnicity or polity.

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Rice presence is not domestication; a polished celt alone is not farming.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

2. Chalcolithic means copper plus stone, not universal metal use or urbanism.

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DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: Culture labels classify assemblages; they do not prove ethnicity or polity.

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Culture labels classify assemblages; they do not prove ethnicity or polity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Culture labels classify assemblages; they do not prove ethnicity or polity.

11

STAGE 11

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

ANSWER SPINE

1. USE 2021 Q37 TO SEPARATE BURZAHOM PITS, CHANDRAKETUGARH

2. COMPARE NORTH-WEST, KASHMIR, GANGA/EAST, NORTH-EAST AND SOUTHERN PATHWAYS.

3. WRITE CLAIM

CHRONOLOGY LIMIT.

RURAL FOOD-PRODUCING CULTURES OVERLAPPED, INTERACTED AND CHANGED UNEVENLY.

ANSWER SPINE

1. Use 2021 Q37 to separate Burzahom pits, Chandraketugarh art and Ganeshwar copper.

2. Compare north-west, Kashmir, Ganga/east, north-east and southern pathways.

3. Write claim → site/culture → evidence → inference → chronology limit.

VERDICT: Rural food-producing cultures overlapped, interacted and changed unevenly.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

ANSWER SPINE

1. Use 2021 Q37 to separate Burzahom pits, Chandraketugarh art and Ganeshwar copper.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

2. Compare north-west, Kashmir, Ganga/east, north-east and southern pathways.

3. Write claim → site/culture → evidence → inference → chronology limit.

DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: Rural food-producing cultures overlapped, interacted and changed unevenly.

ANSWER SPINE

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Rural food-producing cultures overlapped, interacted and changed unevenly.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rural food-producing cultures overlapped, interacted and changed unevenly.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

6. CURRENT LINK

7. MAINS ANGLES

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

Mini-timeline

1. Snapshot & core idea

2. Key classification / data

3. Study links

ADVANCED DEBATE

4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

5. UPSC Traps

6. Current link

7. Mains angles

LEGACY / NUANCE

Optional Advanced Case Clinics: Evidence Without Overreach — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

At Koldihwa, Mahagara, Pachoh and Indari, key issues are dates and whether rice remains are wild or domesticated.

Upinder Singh also highlights Lahuradewa as evidence that the middle Ganga valley

was an early rice-cultivation zone, preventing a single north-west-to-east diffusion model.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

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